

## **Laptop Provision/Charges Policy**

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### **1. Objective**

The objective of this Policy is to support employees in maintaining the essential work-related devices required to perform their job responsibilities effectively. This provision ensures that employees have access to necessary technological equipment, specifically laptops, to effectively perform their work-related functions, either through a fixed allowance for personal laptops or through organization-provided devices, as applicable.

### **2. Scope and Eligibility**

This policy applies to all employees who are eligible to receive the Laptop Charges or Laptop, based on their role, job requirements, and technical needs. Eligibility will be determined by the department head or immediate supervisor.

This Policy governs:

- (a) provision of a fixed monthly disbursement (“Laptop Charges”) for use of personal laptops (Bring Your Own Device / BYOD model); and
- (b) provision of organization-owned laptops for specific roles requiring advanced technical capabilities.

Applicability of specific provisions shall be determined based on the category of device allocated to the employee.

### **3. Laptop Charges**

“Laptop Charges” means a fixed monthly allowance paid to eligible employees to support costs associated with procurement, maintenance, and use of a personal laptop for official purposes.

### **4. Disbursement of Laptop Charges**

- (a) **Monthly Laptop Charges:** Eligible employees will receive a fixed monthly Laptop Charges of INR 5,000/- (Indian Rupees Five Thousand Only). This is intended to support employees in covering the costs associated with the purchase, maintenance, and periodic upgrade of personal laptops necessary for performing work duties.
- (b) **Payment Schedule:** The Laptop Charges shall be disbursed on a monthly basis, within the first week of each month. The payment shall be subject to applicable statutory deductions, including income tax, as per prevailing laws.
- (c) **Non-refundable:** The Laptop Charges are a fixed monthly payment and are not reimbursable or adjustable against any actual costs, purchases, or expenses incurred by the employee. Any

costs incurred in excess of the prescribed monthly amount shall not be compensated by the organisation.

- (d) **Duration of Benefit:** The Laptop Charges shall be payable for a period of 24 months from the employee's date of joining or until the employee's last working day, whichever is earlier.
- (e) **Post-Completion Use:** Upon completion of the 24-month period, the employee shall continue to use and maintain the same laptop for official purposes, provided that the device remains functional and meets the technical and-security requirements prescribed by the organization.

Cessation of Laptop Charges shall not entitle the employee to claim any additional allowance, reimbursement, replacement, or upgrade, unless otherwise approved by the competent authority.

- (f) **Data Handover and Removal upon Separation:** Upon resignation, termination of employment, or any other separation from the organization, employees must transfer, return, or otherwise provide access to all official data, files, records, and work-related information stored on their personal devices to the organization. Employees must also permanently remove any company data from their personal devices upon confirmation from the IT Department or their reporting manager and comply with all applicable data security and exit clearance requirements.

(g) **Suspension or Discontinuation**

Laptop Charges may be suspended or discontinued in the following circumstances:

- i. change in role or eligibility;
- ii. provision of an organization-owned laptop;
- iii. extended leave, absence, or suspension (as per applicable HR policies); or
- iv. non-compliance with this Policy or IT guidelines.

## **5. Organization-Provided Laptops (High-End Laptops)**

For employees whose roles require high-performance laptops (e.g., Information Technology, Software Development, Data Analysis, Video Editing, Graphic Design), the organization will provide these laptops directly as per business and role requirements. The distinction between standard and high-end laptops will be made by the department head, based on the specific needs of the employee's job.

- (a) **Eligibility for High-End Laptops:** Employees whose roles require advanced processing power, higher memory capacity, or specialized hardware/software requirements shall be eligible for a high-end laptop. Such devices will be procured and provided directly by the organization.
- (b) **Approval Process:** The department head will assess the employee's role, responsibilities, and technical requirements to determine the necessity of a high-performance laptop. Final approval shall be subject to organizational guidelines and budgetary considerations.
- (c) **Ownership, Care, and Maintenance:** All high-end laptops provided under this policy shall remain the property of the organization. The organization shall bear the cost of procurement, maintenance and repairs, unless damage is caused due to negligence or misuse of the employees. Employees are responsible for the proper care and safe usage of the device.

- (d) **Incident Reporting:** In the event of malfunction, loss, damage, or technical issues, the employee must promptly notify the IT Department for necessary support and resolution.
- (e) **Use and Return:** Employees shall use organization-provided laptops primarily for official purposes and shall return the device in good condition upon separation or when required.

## **6. Technical and Security Requirements for Personal Laptops – Annexure-1**

Employees using personal laptops under this Policy must ensure compliance with the requirements specified in **Annexure-1**.

The employee's personal laptop will be subject to review, verification and compliance checks by the IT/Admin Department or any authorized personnel. Failure to meet or maintain the prescribed requirements will result in necessary action.

## **7. Employee Responsibilities**

- (a) **Device Maintenance and Security of Personal Laptops:** Employees are responsible for the upkeep, maintenance, and repair of their personal laptops.
- (b) **Work-Related Use of the organization-provided Laptop:** The primary purpose of the laptop given by the organization is for performing work-related tasks. While limited personal use is permitted, it should not interfere with work performance or violate company policies.
- (c) **Confidentiality and Data Protection:** Employees must ensure that their devices safeguard sensitive company information, using secure storage practices, and reporting any security incidents such as device theft or unauthorized access.
- (d) **Security Compliance:** Every Employees shall comply with all IT policies, including installation of security tools, system updates, and access controls as required by the organization.
- (e) **Incident Reporting:** Employees must promptly report any loss, theft, malfunction, or security breach involving their device.

## **8. Limitation of Liability**

The organization shall not be liable for:

- (a) loss, theft, or damage to personal laptops;
- (b) any personal data stored on employee-owned devices; or
- (c) any costs incurred beyond the prescribed Laptop Charges.

## **9. Termination of Benefits**

Eligibility for Laptop Charges shall cease upon termination of employment. Any dues shall be settled in accordance with final settlement processes.

## **10. Exception/ Modification**

Any exception to this policy would require the prior approval of the CEO of MyGov. The policy may be revised/ modified from time to time.

**1. Hardware Requirements**

| Component        | Minimum Specification                                            |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Processor        | Intel Core i5/i7 (13th or 14th Gen) or AMD Ryzen 5/7 7000 Series |
| RAM              | 16 GB DDR4                                                       |
| Storage          | 512 GB NVMe SSD or upto 1 TB                                     |
| Display          | 14" Full HD (1920×1080)                                          |
| Graphics         | Integrated Graphics                                              |
| Battery          | 6 hours                                                          |
| Webcam           | 720p HD                                                          |
| Microphone       | Dual microphone                                                  |
| Speakers         | Standard                                                         |
| Wi-Fi            | Wi-Fi 5                                                          |
| Bluetooth        | Bluetooth 5.0                                                    |
| USB Ports        | 2 × USB-A, 1 × USB-C                                             |
| Operating System | Windows 11 Pro                                                   |

**2. Technical Requirements**
**(a) Operating System**

- Licensed operating system (e.g., Windows 11 Pro, macOS, or approved Linux distribution)
- Automatic security updates enabled
- Latest supported OS version

**(b) Software**

- Only authorized software may be installed and Unlicensed or pirated software is prohibited
- Software installation requires IT approval
- Unsupported or end-of-life software should not be used

**3. Security Requirements**
**(a) Authentication**

- Strong password (minimum 12–14 characters)
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enabled wherever supported
- Automatic screen lock after 10–15 minutes of inactivity
- Password-protected BIOS/UEFI (where applicable)

**(b) Antivirus / Endpoint Protection**

- Enterprise antivirus/EDR installed
- Real-time protection enabled
- Regular malware scans

**(c) Patch Management**

- Security patches installed promptly. (where applicable)
- Critical vulnerabilities addressed as soon as feasible
- Use of latest web browsers version
- Automatic updates enabled where appropriate

#### **4. Data Protection**

- Sensitive data should be encrypted
- Regular backups to approved storage
- The use of USB storage devices shall be restricted. Where their use is authorized, the devices must be password-protected and encrypted
- Do not copy official data to personal cloud storage or personal email or USB

#### **5. Network Security**

##### **(a) Mandatory Guidelines for Using the NIC Network:**

- i. Installation of any software on organizational systems shall be undertaken only with prior approval and authorization from the IT Support Team.
- ii. All users, including permanent and contractual personnel working within NIC premises, shall register their Wi-Fi-enabled devices through the eForms portal (eforms.nic.in). Official work shall be conducted exclusively through the authorized and registered Wi-Fi SSIDs, namely ANANT, SARAS, or VAYU.
- iii. All newly deployed systems (Windows, Linux, or macOS) and any systems connected to the NIC network that do not have endpoint protection shall be equipped with the antivirus/endpoint security solutions (UEM/EDR) prescribed by NIC.
- iv. Only genuine and duly licensed software and operating systems shall be used on organizational devices. The installation or use of pirated, unauthorized, or unlicensed software is strictly prohibited.
- v. Certain network ports may be blocked by the SentinelOne endpoint security solution, potentially impacting applications that utilize such ports. In such cases, the concerned application owner shall coordinate with the IT Team to obtain the necessary port and IP address whitelisting after due review and approval.

##### **(b) Prohibited Practices on the NIC Network**

- i. Users shall not connect or operate any unmanaged network device within the organization's network infrastructure i.e., wireless access points, switch, routers etc. in NIC network.
- ii. Users shall avoid the installation and use of potentially unwanted software (PUS) on organizational systems like Anydesk, Teamviewer etc.
- iii. Do not click on unknown or suspicious links received via email.
- iv. Do not make personal Wi-Fi hotspot from your devices in LAN to get internet connectivity on other devices.
- v. Do not allow personal smart devices (e.g., smartwatches, fitness trackers) to connect to the MeitY (NIC) network unless on a dedicated guest network with restricted access.
- vi. Employee shall not save passwords in browsers or use default passwords on devices and systems.
- vii. Do not disable security features (e.g., firewalls, encryption, MFA) without documented risk assessments and approvals.